

Let's suppose a customer uses a contextual chatbot to order pizza. The chatbot will store the data from each conversation – details like what the user likes to order frequently. Next time, when the customer interacts with this chatbot to order pizza, it merely asks, "Do you want to repeat this order?" As a result, instead of having to respond to several questions, the user has to just answer with a "Yes," and the pizza is ready to be despatched.

What's trending?

The bot market is slowly maturing, and companies are trying to increase the features and capacity of chatbots.

Facebook is presently using natural language processing (NLP) technology. This is advanced enough to understand all kinds of user requests. But the new trend is natural language understanding (NLU). Many companies are also investing a lot of money in developing new technologies like reinforcement learning (RL). All this will make chatbots more effective.

Many people now feel that voice is the best way to converse with chatbots. In the age of Amazon Echo, Google Home and Apple Home, voice assistants are becoming common. User interface elements like images, interactive buttons and message menus make chatbots more effective, resulting in bot platforms like Slack, Telegram, etc.

Labour efficiency, cost savings and enterprise automation are the main benefits of chatbots. Today, an employee need not spend hours on routine office chores like password resets, printer issues, technical support, etc. There are IT Helpdesk bots for that! In short, AI chatbots can take employee experiences in the workplace to a new level in the future.

The obstacles

There are many challenges while dealing with chatbots. Different people have their own ways of typing messages. Some use short sentences and some long sentences. In such cases, to understand user intention is really a challenge for the chatbot. Further, these bots need to have robust security. So before making a chatbot live, it is necessary to test security protocols to make sure that there are no gaps in its defences.

Chatbots need to be useful, reliable, accurate and seem trustworthy to customers. Also, sophisticated knowledge about machine learning coding, NLP software and other technical knowhow is required for developing a chatbot.

The future

Brand-building is one of the biggest challenges for a business. So a chatbot should add something to a marketing site to build up the brand image of an enterprise. It should have rich analytic programs to analyse the most common requests by customers.

Technology is changing frighteningly fast. So it is necessary to provide future-proof chatbots.

Chatbots can be game changers in the marketing, sales and services sectors. By 2020, 80 per cent of people's needs are expected to be met by chatbots instead of expensive apps. Chatbots do not need any installing or downloading requirements. 24×7 real-time communication by chatbots can definitely strengthen a company's customer support. Today, chatbots can mine information from various digital data channels using sophisticated data mining technology and provide an effective solution to your problems.

Chatbots are being widely used across the US, where several startups and enterprises are entering the business. Usage of chatbots is also increasing in Asia. The Chinese prefer to integrate the WeChat bot into retail, daily life and social media usage. In Japan, prompt and polite customer service is important to businesses and consumers. Here, chatbots are enabling customer loyalty programs and services. In Taiwan, chatbots are being used extensively for banking and financial services. When we speak about India, there is a lot of diversity—in needs, culture, infrastructure and usage. So any chatbot platform has to be able to encompass all of these smoothly.

There are thousands of chatbots in India as of now. Big brands like HDFC, Yatra, etc, are introducing chatbots into their websites. India has traditionally been a late adopter of advanced technologies. However, when it comes to chatbots, India is a key player. There were more than a hundred chatbot startups in India as of 2017.

With chatbots playing a vital role in today's IT world, researchers are under pressure to develop reliable and economical designs. The need of the hour is to be able to predict the behaviour of chatbots to a very high degree, in order to ensure reliability. This has led to advanced chatbots with increased data flow, which are set to become an industry default. Researchers are working on creating chatbots capable of collecting, processing and analysing a huge amount of data, helping users to get useful and effective solutions to their problems. **END** 

References

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